Mikhail Balkhaev

ML Engineer / Generative AI Engineer / Product Developer

Moscow, Russia m.balkhaev@gmail.com +7 966 006-60-68 t.me/balkhaev balkhaev.com



Software developer with 14 years of experience. I worked on Delivery Club at VK and on Yandex Eats at Yandex, and since 2024 I have been building generative AI products: image and video diffusion pipelines, LoRA training, text-to-speech, RAG and local LLM inference.

Experience

AIGF, luv.club — Mar 2026 – present
Generative AI Engineer

- Building luv.club, an 18+ AI companion platform with image and video generation. I work on the whole product: WebSocket API, queue workers, website and admin panel.
- Image and video generation on RunPod with Qwen Image 2.1 and H3: characters, outfits, scenes and face swap.
- 3D-to-video: the reference 3D render guides only the first 5 of 20 sampling steps. The camera and composition stay in place, and the model is free to make the motion natural.
- An API and MCP server that let external agents create characters, scenes and shoots.

Funcorp, Cyprus — Nov 2024 – Mar 2026
Senior Product Developer

- Started on the main product, then moved to building new AI products from scratch.
- Image and video generation with Wan 2.2, LTX, SD and SDXL in ComfyUI and DiffSynth-Studio; dataset preparation and LoRA training.
- Text-to-speech: voice design and fine-tuning the model for natural-sounding speech.
- LLM features and RAG with Qwen3.5-9B, ChatGPT, Grok and Qdrant.
- Next.js, Hono, Kafka, ClickHouse, PostgreSQL, Redis, FFmpeg.

Yandex, Moscow — Oct 2022 – Aug 2024
Frontend Developer

- Moved from VK with the Delivery Club team into the Yandex Eats advertising unit. Most of the work was analytics and testing ad hypotheses.
- Maintained the main Yandex Eats and Yandex Vendor webviews and improved the micro-frontend architecture.
- Built an ad runner game with a courier. The first partner was Haval, which was entering the Russian market at the time: the courier became a car, with billboards along the road.
- Implemented most of the banner ads, debugged analytics and proposed new metrics.

VK, Delivery Club — Jun 2020 – Oct 2022
Lead Developer

- Maintained delivery-club.ru, effectively as a full-stack developer.
- Built admin panels for partners and the legal team, and new ad formats.
- Wrote internal libraries: UI components and API helpers.
- After an incident, built a document tool for the legal team with versioning and audit logs.

Data-screen, Moscow — Jun 2019 – Mar 2020
Full-stack Developer

- Turned high-level ideas into working features and made the technical decisions myself. The main project, a sports streaming service, was put on hold because of COVID.
- Node.js, Express, React, Docker, Redis, PostgreSQL, Nginx.

Smart Solution, Moscow — Nov 2015 – Dec 2018
Senior Frontend Developer

- Frontend for about ten high-traffic, server-rendered sites in the Alexa top 50: rewrote legacy code, optimized business logic, set up builds.
- Responsible for advertising: banners, web push and popunders.
- Trained new developers, reviewed code and maintained technical documentation.

Earlier

Oversun, Web Developer — 2014 – 2015
WordPress sites from scratch with custom modules; led a junior developer on the company website.

Ideegroupe, Sochi, Web Developer — 2013
WordPress and ModX: modules for a city news portal, SQL optimization.

RedBox, Buryatia, HTML Developer — 2011 – 2012
Joomla and WordPress templates, first responsive layouts, jQuery.

Projects

Inference. A job queue for my home RTX 5080 and a laptop RTX 4080 that serve image generation. Each job reserves resources based on the average load of its type, a model stays loaded when the next job needs it, and jobs run in parallel when there is room.

Local LLM. Qwen3.8-Flash-Next (125B) through Strata at about 100 tokens/s on an RTX 5080 with 64 GB of RAM, driven by DeepSeek Harness with the dsh-purge plugin.

balkhaev.com. Falling into a Schwarzschild black hole in the browser: WebGL ray tracing in Painlevé–Gullstrand coordinates.

ggpick.club. An SEO site about games with 200+ unique visitors a day.

Skills

Generative AI	Wan 2.2, LTX, SD, SDXL, Qwen Image, H3, ComfyUI, DiffSynth-Studio, LoRA training, TTS, FFmpeg
LLM	RAG, Qdrant, embeddings, local inference, agents, MCP
Backend	Node.js, Bun, Hono, Python, Django, Kafka, ClickHouse, PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, MongoDB, GraphQL, REST, Docker
Frontend	TypeScript, React, Next.js, Vue, WebGL, micro-frontends, Webpack, SEO

Languages

Russian: native
English: basic (A1)

Education

Secondary education

Availability

Full-time, part-time or project work. Remote, hybrid or on-site. Open to business travel and relocation within Russia.